

Aren Clissold

Full Stack / Backend Developer

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Full-stack developer with four years at Aeon Media, growing into main backend responsibility. Builds Ruby on Rails and GraphQL APIs, React/Next.js interfaces and AWS systems, turning editorial requirements into production features. Delivered a migration that reduced overall image-processing costs by approximately 80%.

Technical skills

Backend & data: Ruby, Ruby on Rails, GraphQL, PostgreSQL, SQL, Redis, OpenSearch
Frontend: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, HTML/CSS, Tailwind CSS, TanStack Query
Cloud & tools: AWS (ECS, Lambda, CloudFront, S3, RDS), Terraform, Git, ElevenLabs API

Professional experience

Full Stack Web Developer | Aeon Media Group Ltd

July 2022 - June 2026

- Reduced overall image-related costs by approximately 80%, including added AWS costs, by moving Vercel image optimisation into AWS (CloudFront, Lambda, S3) in May 2025. Implemented infrastructure, backend and frontend changes; partnered with the SRE on Terraform deployment.
- Owned backend/API design and implementation for the authentication and CMS migration to GraphQL (Jan - Mar 2025). Kept APIs within Rails and introduced separate Next.js frontends alongside the old UI, enabling gradual adoption by approximately 30-40 editors and production staff.
- Worked with publishing staff on requirements and usability in a five-person engineering team. Contributed frontend architecture and implementation using shadcn and TanStack Query, enabling React/Next.js developers to work on these tools. The image pipeline later enabled CMS cropping, replacing manual local crops.
- Headed AI-generated article-audio implementation for Aeon and Psyche using the ElevenLabs API (Oct - Dec 2025). Built backend APIs and infrastructure and coordinated frontend audio-player design, production quality requirements and marketing's podcast releases.
- Improved narration quality with date/number preprocessing and CMS pronunciation controls developed with production staff. Also contributed to two-factor authentication and session-management improvements.

IT Support Technician | Easyweb Digital

July 2021 - April 2022

- Prepared and tested networking equipment for a programme serving 500+ Australian evacuation centres; assembled cabinets, flashed software and supported contractor activation and proxy connectivity by phone.
- Prepared and tested equipment for the 2022 Sydney Royal Easter Show; engineers handled configuration and a contractor handled installation.

Teaching Assistant | Le Wagon

July 2022 - July 2023 | Freelance

- Supported students learning Ruby on Rails, JavaScript and full-stack development through debugging, pair programming and collaborative projects.

Education and languages

Bachelor of Biomedical Science | Monash University | awarded Jan 2021

Full-stack Web Development Bootcamp | Le Wagon | April - June 2022

English: native/bilingual proficiency. Japanese: JLPT N2 (Aug 2025); studying for N1 in December 2026.